Week 11 Notes

STAT 251 SECTION 01

Lecture 21

Warm Up: Consider the following example - a gardener is conducting an experiment to evaluate the effectiveness of a new fertilizer on the heights of tomato plants. They purchase 80 tomato plants from their local seedling outlet. The gardener randomly selects 40 of plants to receive a fertilizer and water mixture and the remaining half to receive only water. After one month the mean height is recorded in both groups and the difference in height between the two experimental groups of tomato plants is measured.

The gardener suspects that the plants which received the new fertilizer will tend to be taller than the plants that received only water. They set the null hypothesis to be "no difference in height" which can be thought of as "the fertilizer has no effect on tomato plant growth".

$$H_0 : \mu_d = 0$$

μ_d denotes the population mean difference in tomato plant height between the two experimental groups. We can use the sample mean difference $\bar{x}_d$ to estimate μ_d which is calculated as

$$\bar{x}_d = \frac{1}{n}\sum_i (x_i - y_i)$$

where x_i is the height of tomato plants receiving the fertilizer and y_i is the height the tomato plants receiving only water.

Since the suspicion is that the plants receiving fertilizer will be taller, the alternative hypothesis is

$$H_A : \mu_d > 0$$

The data from the gardeners experiment are shown below:

Height Fertilized (Inches)	Height Water Only (Inches)	Difference In Height (Inches)
43.60	38.15	5.45
44.42	40.15	4.28
48.90	35.81	13.08

Height Fertilized (Inches)	Height Water Only (Inches)	Difference In Height (Inches)
45.18	49.89	-4.72
45.32	45.95	-0.63
49.29	36.40	12.89
46.15	39.35	6.80
41.84	39.09	2.75
43.28	44.20	-0.91
43.89	40.66	3.23
48.06	42.04	6.02
45.90	40.88	5.02
46.00	40.82	5.18
45.28	46.61	-1.33
43.61	40.07	3.54
49.47	47.22	2.25
46.24	34.65	11.59
40.08	43.40	-3.31
46.75	41.51	5.25
43.82	41.89	1.93
42.33	42.56	-0.23
44.46	38.94	5.51
42.43	39.63	2.80
43.18	36.82	6.35
43.44	36.61	6.83
40.78	42.24	-1.46

Height Fertilized (Inches)	Height Water Only (Inches)	Difference In Height (Inches)
47.09	42.84	4.26
45.38	41.22	4.17
42.15	44.78	-2.63
48.13	49.41	-1.27
46.07	38.99	7.08
44.26	31.53	12.73
47.24	45.12	2.11
47.20	38.09	9.10
47.05	38.18	8.87
46.72	45.20	1.52
46.38	39.83	6.55
44.85	36.00	8.85
44.24	41.74	2.49
44.05	40.43	3.62

The summary statistics from the gardeners data are listed below

Name	Symbol	Value
Sample size	n	40.00
Mean Height (Fertilized)	$\bar{x}$	45.11
SD (Fertilized)	s_x	2.24
Mean Height (Water Only)	$\bar{y}$	40.97
SD (Water Only)	s_y	3.93
Mean Difference (Fertilized - Water Only)	$\bar{x}_d$	4.14
SD Difference	s_d	4.43

Recall from last week that a significance test is a test of the null hypothesis. To test the null hypothesis, we compute the scenario given by the alternative hypothesis under the assumption that the null is true. In the case of this gardeners experiment, we need to compute the probability of observing a mean difference larger than the difference we observed under the sampling distribution of the null hypothesis. In other words, "how likely is it that we would see a difference in height as large as the one we observed, assuming that the true difference is zero?"

$$P(\bar{X} \geq \bar{x}_d | H_0 \text{ true})$$

To compute this probability, we need convert the difference we observed into a standardized score that we can look up in one of our tables. Since we are discussing a "mean" difference we can use the t-distribution as we did before with confidence intervals:

$$t_{obs} = \frac{\bar{x}_d - \mu_d}{s_d/\sqrt{n}} = \frac{4.14 - 0}{4.43/\sqrt{40}} = 5.91 \sim t(n-1)$$

Where $\bar{x}_d$ is the sample mean difference in height, μ_d is population mean difference under the null hypothesis, and s_d is the sample standard deviation for the difference in height. The above formula converts the observed difference $\bar{x}_d$ to a t-score from a t-distribution with $n-1$ degrees of freedom under the assumption that the null hypothesis is true. t_{obs} is called the **test statistic** - it measures the discrepancy (distance) between the point estimate of the parameter and the hypothesized value of the parameter under the null hypothesis. It tells us approximately how many standard deviations the observed mean difference is from the population mean difference under the null.

Using the above formula the gardener calculates a t-score of $t_{obs} = 5.91$ with 39 degrees of freedom. The probability from earlier can be re-framed in the context of the t-distribution

$$P(t \geq t_{\text{obs}} | H_0 \text{ true}) = 1 - P(t < t_{\text{obs}} | H_0 \text{ true})$$

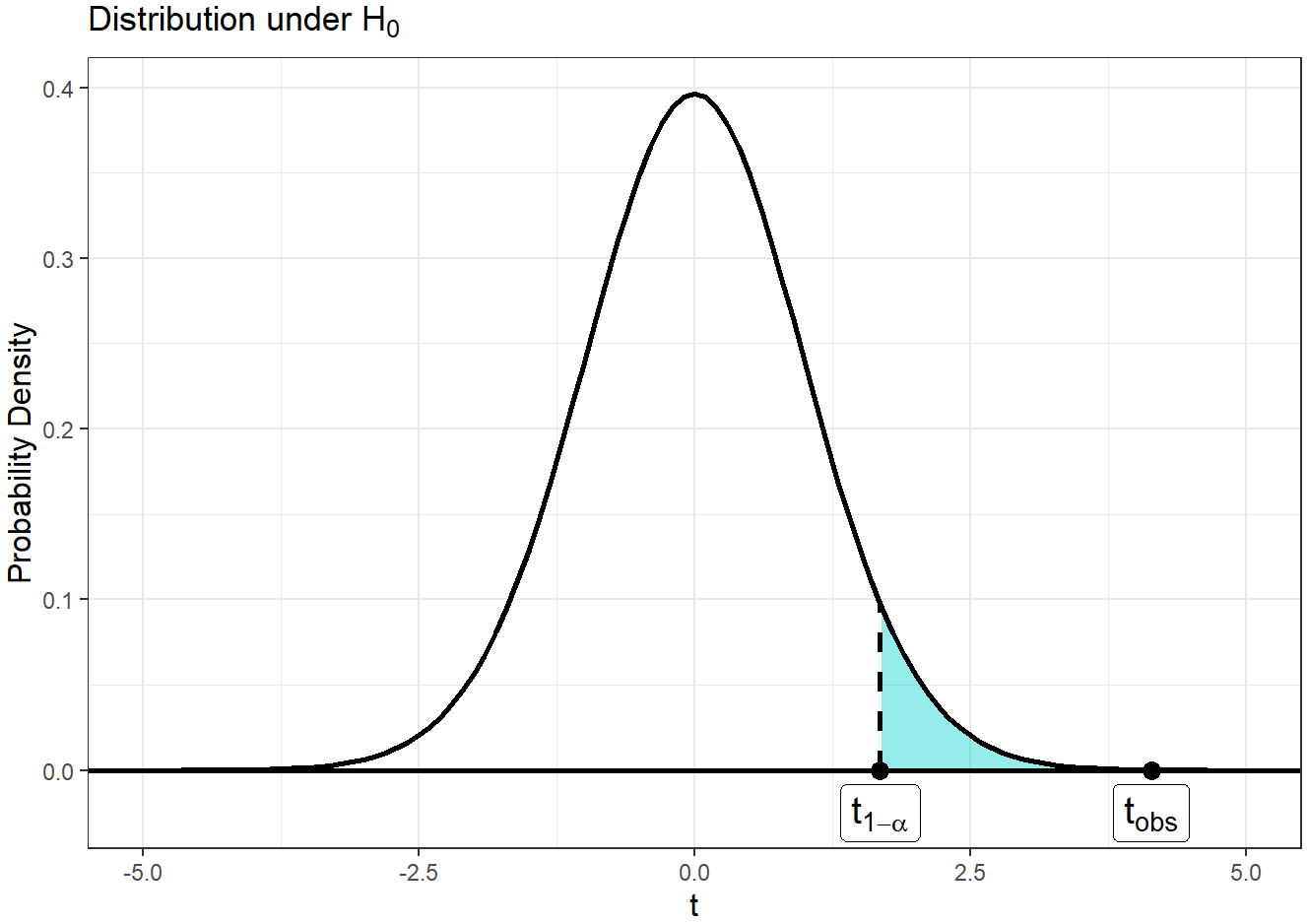
i.e the probability of observing a t value greater than the one we observed when the true difference is assumed to be $\mu_d = 0$. For the gardener's experiment, this probability is $3.39 \times 10^{-7} \approx 0$, which is very small.

This probability is called the **p-value** and it measures the probability of observing an estimate as or more extreme than the one we observed under the assumption that the null hypothesis is true. So what does this small probability mean? Just as we observed with the coin flip example from last week, it can mean one of two things:

1. We observed something very unusual

2. The assumption underlying the calculation (i.e $\mu_d = 0$ no difference in mean height) is not true.

We prefer the second conclusion when the p-value is "sufficiently" small and take it as evidence against the null hypothesis. So how small is small enough? By convention, most tests use a probability cutoff of 5% or less which is called the **significance level** of the test. The significance level of a test is denoted as α. For the gardeners test $\alpha = 0.05$. α sets the boundary for how big (or small) the test statistic needs to be to conclude that the test statistic is statistically significant.



In the plot above, $t_{1-\alpha}$ denotes the boundary for significance in the gardener's test. Any t-value greater than $t_{1-\alpha}$ will have a **p-value** less than α and be deemed *significant*

What were the steps involved with this test?

- **step 1** - The first step in any hypothesis test is to address the assumptions we make about the data. The hypothesis tests we will learn in this class assume that the data are produced by a randomization process. There may also be assumptions about the population distribution.
- **step 2** - Formulate the question you wish to evaluate and set up the null and alternative hypotheses.

- **step 3** - Calculate the **test statistic** which measures the discrepancy (distance) between the the estimate of the parameter and the hypothesized value of the parameter under the null.
- **step 4** - Compute the p**-value** - the probability of observing a value of the test statistic that is as extreme or more extreme than the observed value given that the null hypothesis is true
- **step 5** - Make a conclusion about the null hypothesis - we either (i) fail to reject the null hypothesis and conclude that there is not sufficient evidence in favor of the alternative or (ii) reject the null hypothesis in favor of the alternative

With the examples of significance tests we have discussed thus far we have learned two formal significance tests: one concerning a population proportion p and one concerning a population mean μ.

Setting up the null and alternative hypothesis

As we stated previously, the null hypothesis is a statement about the value of a population parameter. The alternative hypothesis is a statement about our suspicions regarding the value of that parameter. The alternative hypothesis can be directional such as $H_A : p > p_0$ (called an upper tail test) or $H_A : p < p_0$ (called a lower tailed test). These types of alternative hypotheses are called *one-sided* because they direct our attention to either the lower or upper tail of the distribution of the test statistic. If our suspicion about the parameter is that it differs in either direction or if we are unsure, the alternative hypothesis is $H_A : p \neq p_0$ and the test is called *two-sided* because the suspicion includes both the lower and upper tails of the distribution of the test statistic.

Because the alternative hypothesis expresses some effect that we hope to find evidence for, we often begin by stating H_A and then set up H_0 as the statement that the "hoped-for" effect is not present. It's important to note that the alternative hypothesis should express the hopes or suspicions we bring to the data. It is biased to first look at the data and then set up the alternative hypothesis based on what the data show. If you do not have a direction firmly in mind before gathering the data you must use a two-sided test.

Significance level, critical value, and decision making

The **significance level** of test (denoted α) is how we turn the p-value of a significance test into a *reject/not reject* decision about the null hypothesis. It sets how "strong" the evidence against the null needs to be in order for a result to be deemed statistically significant. The researcher determines the significance level before conducting the experiment.

The **critical value** of a significance test is a point on the distribution of the test statistic that defines a set of values that call for rejecting the null hypothesis.

The critical value determines the boundary of the **rejection region** – the area in the tail (or tails) of the distribution of the test statistic for which a result is deemed significant. The rejection region has an area of exactly α.

The significance level, critical value, and rejection region are all related to each other but we typically only set the significance level. The critical value and rejection region then follow from the specified significance level. All three of these things are used to help us turn the p-value of a hypothesis test into a formal decision about the null hypothesis. The decision rule is as follows:

1. If p-value $< \alpha$, then *reject* H_0 (results are statistically significant)
2. If p-value $\geq \alpha$, then *do not reject* H_0 (results are <u>not</u> statistically significant)

So how does this relate the to critical value and rejection region? We can state the decision rule in terms of both of these quantities but to do so is more nuanced and depends on the direction (or lack there of) of the alternative hypothesis. For example, consider the null hypothesis and alternative hypotheses

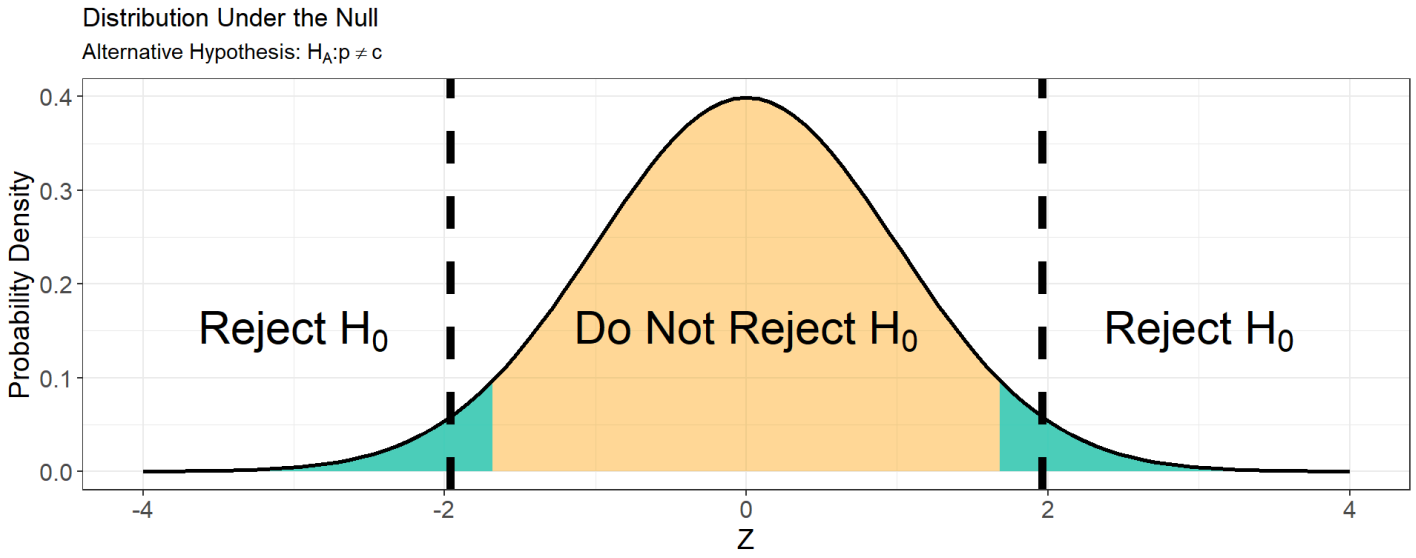
$$H_0 : \mu = \mu_0$$

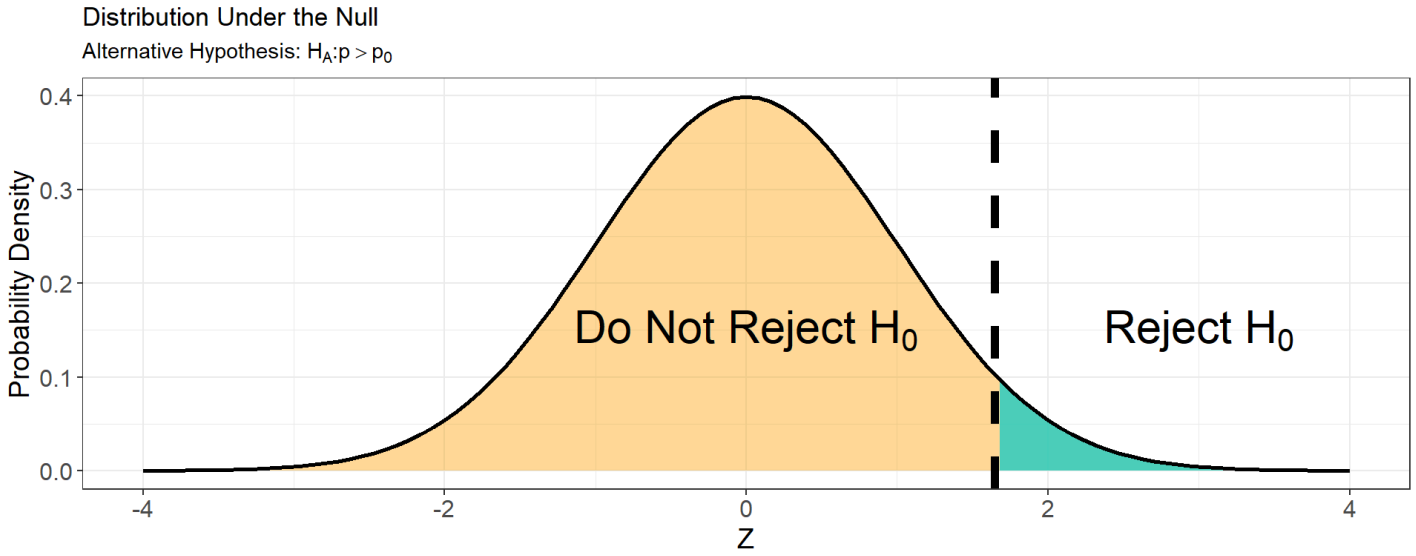
$$H_A : \mu < \mu_0$$

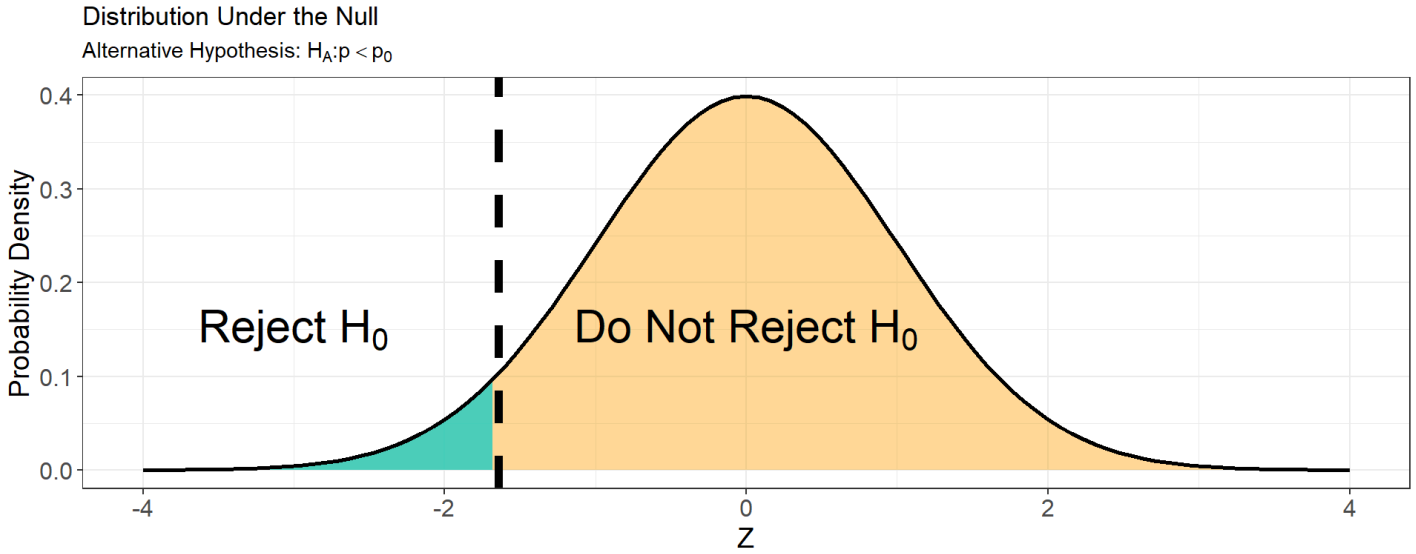
The decision rule stated in terms of the critical value and rejection region is:

1. If p-value $< \alpha$ then $t_{obs} < t_\alpha$; *reject* H_0 (results are statistically significant) - this is the same as saying "if the test statistic falls within the rejection region then <u>reject</u> H_0"
2. If p-value $\geq \alpha$, then $t_{obs} \geq t_\alpha$; *do not reject* H_0 (results are <u>not</u> statistically significant) - this is the same as saying "if the test statistic does not fall within the rejection region then <u>do not reject</u> H_0"

The **critical value** and **rejection region** of a test depend on the significance level of the test and the direction of the alternative hypothesis. Consider the plots below:

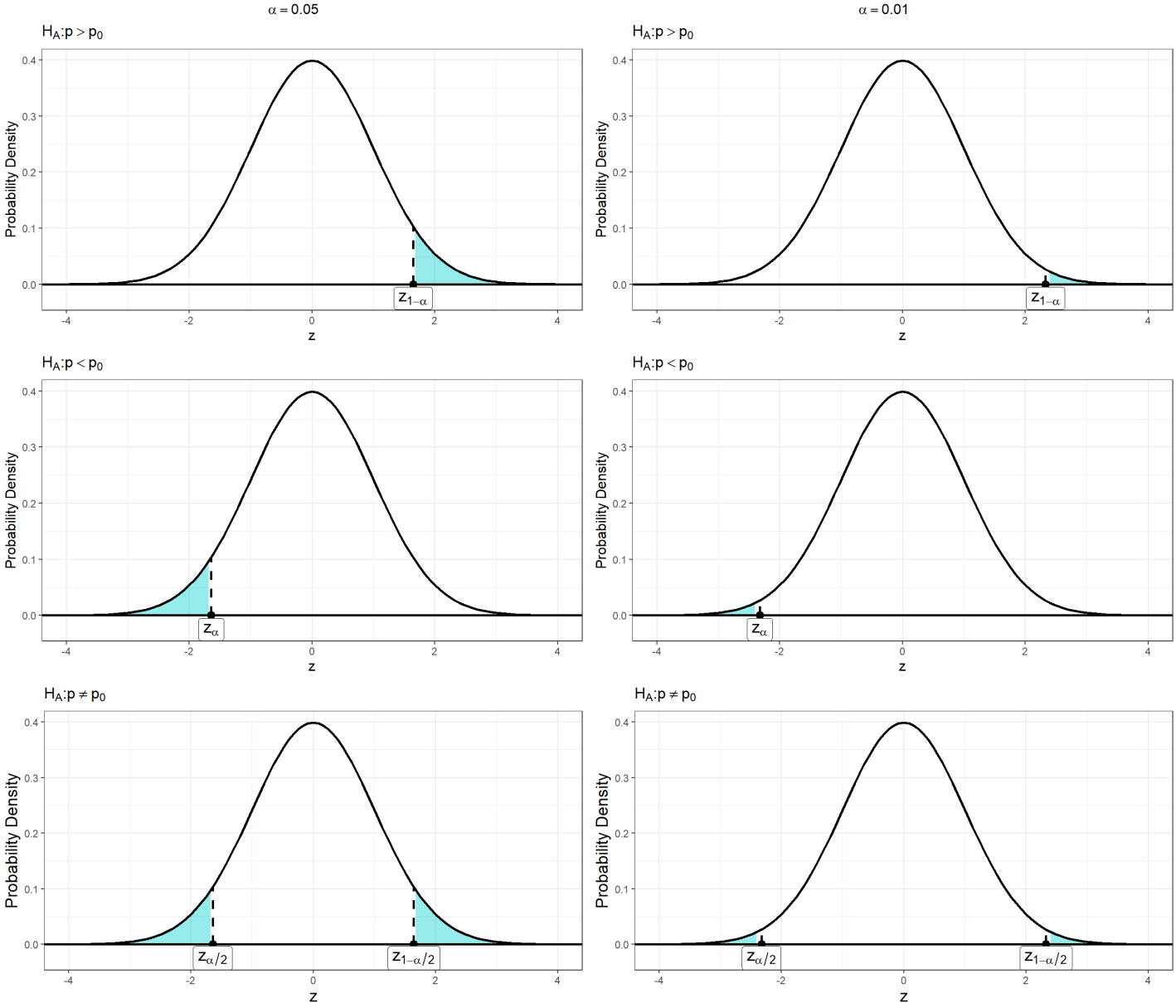






This plot depicts the decision rule for a given alternative hypothesis at a significance level $\alpha = 0.05$. In each subplot, the rejection region is highlighted in turquoise and the critical value(s) are denoted by the vertical dashed lines.

Consider the six plots below which show the position of the critical value, and rejection region for the three types of alternative hypotheses at two significance levels. What do you notice about the relationship between the significance level and the rejection region?



Notice from the plots above that the alternative hypothesis also impacts how significant a result must be in order to reject the null. Specifically, a result need not be as extreme under the alternative hypotheses $H_A : p > p_0$ and $H_A : p < p_0$ to be statistically significant. This is because when we suspect the direction of the effect we have more information about the parameter which improves our ability to detect a significant result.

Significance tests concerning p

The following are the steps for conducting a significance tests for a population proportion:

1. **Assumptions**

- The sample size is sufficiently large. The sample size is sufficiently large whenever $np_0 \geq 15$ and $n(1-p_0) \geq 15$ where p_0 is the value of p specified under the null hypothesis. If these conditions are not met the inference may not be correct.

2. **State the null and alternative hypotheses**. For a constant c the null hypothesis is

$$H_0 : p = c$$

- the alternative hypotheses, critical values, and rejection regions are listed below:

Alternative Hypothesis	Critical Value	Rejection Region
$H_A : p \neq p_0$	$Z_{1-\alpha/2}$	$-\infty \leq Z \leq Z_{\alpha/2}$ or $Z_{1-\alpha/2} \leq Z \leq \infty$
$H_A : p > p_0$	$Z_{1-\alpha}$	$Z_{1-\alpha} \leq Z \leq \infty$
$H_A : p < p_0$	Z_{α}	$-\infty \leq Z \leq Z_{\alpha}$

3. **Compute the test statistic**

$$Z_{obs} = \frac{\hat{p} - p_0}{\sqrt{\frac{p_0(1-p_0)}{n}}} \sim N(0,1)$$

4. **Compute the p-value.**

- Under the assumption in [1.] the test statistic follows a standard normal distribution. The p-value corresponding to each alternative hypothesis is given below:

Alternative Hypothesis	p-value
$H_A : p \neq p_0$	$P(Z \geq \lvert Z_{obs} \rvert \lvert H_0 \text{ True})$
$H_A : p > p_0$	$P(Z \geq Z_{obs} \lvert H_0 \text{ True})$
$H_A : p < p_0$	$P(Z \leq Z_{obs} \lvert H_0 \text{ True})$

5. **Draw a conclusion**: if p-value $< \alpha$ *reject* H_0. Else *fail to reject* H_0.

Practice:

1. A leading electric vehicle (EV) manufacturer claims that at least 20% of all vehicles sold in a particular region are electric. To verify this claim, a consumer advocacy group randomly surveys 500 recent vehicle purchases in the region and finds that 115 of them are electric. Conduct a

significance test at the $\alpha = 0.01$ significance level to determine if the proportion of vehicles sold is less than the manufacturer's claim.

Solution. Here $n = 500$, $p_0 = 0.20$, and the sample proportion is $\hat{p} = 115/500 = 0.23$. We test $H_0 : p = 0.20$ against the lower-tail alternative $H_A : p < 0.20$ at $\alpha = 0.01$.

- **Check the assumption.** $np_0 = 500(0.20) = 100 \geq 15$ and $n(1 - p_0) = 500(0.80) = 400 \geq 15$, so the sample is large enough for the normal approximation.
- **Test statistic.**

$$Z_{obs} = \frac{\hat{p} - p_0}{\sqrt{\frac{p_0(1-p_0)}{n}}} = \frac{0.23 - 0.20}{\sqrt{\frac{0.20(0.80)}{500}}} = \frac{0.03}{0.0179} = 1.68$$

- **p-value.** For the lower-tail alternative, $p\text{-value} = P(Z \leq 1.68) \approx 0.95$.
- **Conclusion.** Since the p-value ≈ 0.95 is far greater than $\alpha = 0.01$, we *fail to reject* H_0. The observed proportion (0.23) is actually above the claimed 0.20, so there is no evidence that the true proportion of EVs is less than 20%.

Significance tests concerning μ

The following are the steps for conducting a significance test for a population mean:

1. **Assumptions**

- The population distribution is approximately normal. This can be checked by making a plot of the data.

2. **State the null and alternative hypotheses**. For a constant c the null hypothesis is

$$H_0 : \mu = c$$

- the alternative hypotheses, critical values, and rejection regions are listed below:

Alternative Hypothesis	Critical Value	Rejection Region
$H_A : \mu \neq \mu_0$	$t_{n-1,1-\alpha/2}$	$t_{n-1,1-\alpha/2} \leq t \leq \infty$
$H_A : \mu > \mu_0$	$t_{n-1,1-\alpha}$	$t_{n-1,1-\alpha} \leq t \leq \infty$
$H_A : \mu < \mu_0$	$t_{n-1,\alpha}$	$-\infty \leq t \leq t_{n-1,\alpha}$

3. **Compute the test statistic**

$$t_{obs} = \frac{\bar{x} - \mu_0}{s/\sqrt{n}} \sim t(n-1)$$

4. **Compute the p-value.**

- Under the assumption in [1.] the test statistic follows a t distribution with $n-1$ degrees of freedom. The p-value corresponding to each alternative hypothesis is given below:

Alternative Hypothesis	p-value
$H_A : \mu \neq \mu_0$	$P(t \geq \lvert t_{obs} \rvert \lvert H_0 \text{ True})$
$H_A : \mu > \mu_0$	$P(t \geq t_{obs} \lvert H_0 \text{ True})$
$H_A : \mu < \mu_0$	$P(t \leq t_{obs} \lvert H_0 \text{ True})$

5. **Draw a conclusion**: if p-value $< \alpha$ *reject* H_0. Else *fail to reject* H_0.

Practice:

1. A government agency is interested in understanding the average annual income of households in a particular region to inform economic policies. The agency hypothesizes that the mean annual income of households in this region is $\$50,000$. To test this, they collect a random sample of 100 households from the region and estimate the annual income to be $\$45,323$ with a standard deviation of $\$13,121$. Conduct a hypothesis test at the $\alpha = 0.05$ significance level to determine if the annual income is significantly different than the agency's hypothesis for this region.

Solution. Here $n = 100$, $\bar{x} = 45{,}323$, $s = 13{,}121$, and $\mu_0 = 50{,}000$. Because we are asked whether the mean is *different* (in either direction), we test $H_0 : \mu = 50{,}000$ against the two-sided alternative $H_A : \mu \neq 50{,}000$ at $\alpha = 0.05$.

- **Check the assumption.** The sample size $n = 100$ is large, so by the Central Limit Theorem the sampling distribution of $\bar{x}$ is approximately normal.
- **Test statistic.**

$$t_{obs} = \frac{\bar{x} - \mu_0}{s/\sqrt{n}} = \frac{45{,}323 - 50{,}000}{13{,}121/\sqrt{100}} = \frac{-4677}{1312.1} = -3.57 \sim t(99)$$

- **p-value.** For the two-sided alternative, $p\text{-value} = 2 \times P(t \leq -3.57) \approx 0.0006$.
- **Conclusion.** Since the p-value ≈ 0.0006 is less than $\alpha = 0.05$, we *reject* H_0. There is strong evidence that the mean annual household income differs from $\$50{,}000$ (specifically, the data suggest it is lower).

Relationship between two-sided tests and confidence intervals

Recall the basic idea of a confidence interval. We construct an interval that includes the true value of the parameter μ or p with specified frequency $100(1-\alpha)\%$. Now consider a two-sided significance test for a population mean. A two-sided test constructs an **acceptance region** around the value of the parameter suggested in the null hypothesis (i.e μ_0). At the $100(1-\alpha)\%$ confidence level, this acceptance region is given by $[\mu_0 - t_{1-\alpha/2} \times \frac{s}{\sqrt{n}}, \mu_0 + t_{1-\alpha/2} \times \frac{s}{\sqrt{n}}]$. Values of $\bar{x}$ that are not in this interval seem to be incompatible with the data. Thus when $\bar{x}$ is not in this interval, it is statistically significant and the null hypothesis is rejected. This produces a significance test at $\alpha = 0.05$ significance level.

Example

Return to the household income problem above ($\mu_0 = 50{,}000$, $n = 100$, $\bar{x} = 45{,}323$, $s = 13{,}121$, $\alpha = 0.05$). The standard error is $s/\sqrt{n} = 13{,}121/\sqrt{100} = 1312.1$, and with $n - 1 = 99$ degrees of freedom the critical value is $t_{99,\,0.975} \approx 1.984$. The 95% acceptance region around μ_0 is

$$[50{,}000 - 1.984 \times 1312.1, \quad 50{,}000 + 1.984 \times 1312.1] = [47{,}397,\ \ 52{,}603]$$

The observed sample mean $\bar{x} = 45{,}323$ falls **outside** this interval, so we reject H_0 at the $\alpha = 0.05$ level. This is exactly the same decision we reached with the test statistic ($t_{obs} = -3.57$, p-value $\approx 0.0006 < 0.05$): a two-sided test rejects H_0 precisely when the observed $\bar{x}$ lies outside the $100(1-\alpha)\%$ acceptance region centered at μ_0.

Types of Errors

Conducting a hypothesis test is a simple-enough procedure in the modern age as many software programs effortlessly give out a p-value for a chosen test and dataset. However, using tests wisely is another matter entirely. A single significant result is not irrefutable evidence of a statistical relationship. This is because all tests come with a probability of making an error. Moreover, other factors can influence the outcome of a test such as the presence of outliers in the data. In addition, when sample sizes are very large, even tiny deviations from the null hypothesis can be deemed significant - this is related to the **power** of a test.

Statistical **power** is the ability to reject the null hypothesis when it is, in fact, false. For example, the power of a right-tailed (or upper tail) test of a population mean is given by

$$Power = P(t > t_{1-\alpha} | H_0 \text{ Not True})$$

There are several factors that influence the power of a statistical test. Some of the ways to increase power are:

1. Increase the sample size
2. Increase the significance level α
3. Choose a more powerful test

The significance level of a test, like the confidence level, tells us how reliable the test is in repeated use. Thus a test at $\alpha = 0.05$ significance level will return the correct result $95/100$ times when H_0 is in fact true and when the test is conducted on data arising from the same conditions. The $5/100$ times that the test gives the incorrect result is called the **type I error** rate

The **type I error** rate is the probability that we reject the null when the null is in fact true (denoted α).

For example, the probability of committing a type I error for a right-tailed (or upper tail) test of a population mean is

$$P(t > t_{1-\alpha} | H_0 \text{ True}) = \alpha$$

Another type of error that can occur is called a **type II error** (denoted β). This type of error occurs when we fail to reject the null hypothesis but the alternative hypothesis is true.

The probability of committing a type II error for a right-tailed (or upper tail) test of a population mean is

$$P(t \leq t_{1-\alpha} | H_0 \text{ Is not True}) = \beta$$

Looking at the previous example it is easy to see that power is the complement of the type II error rate.

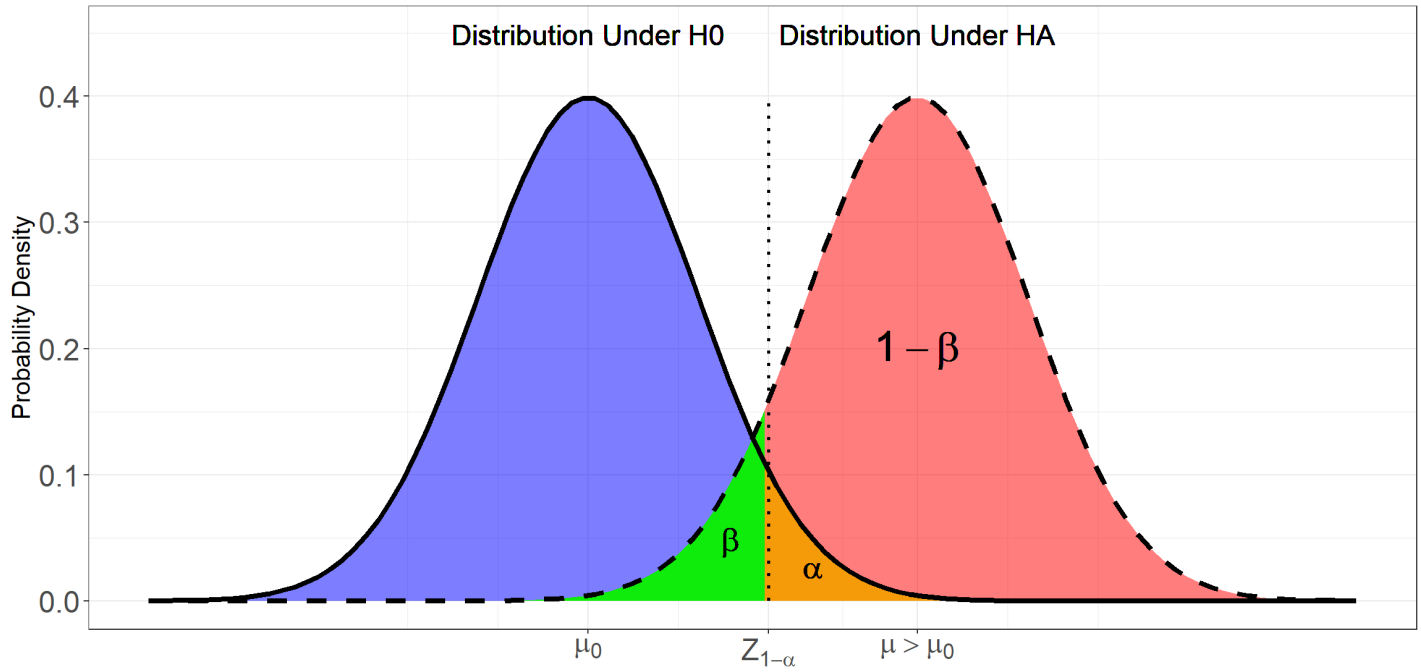
$$Power = P(t \geq t_{1-\alpha} | H_0 \text{ Not True}) = 1 - P(t \leq t_{1-\alpha} | H_0 \text{ Is not True})$$

$$= 1 - \beta$$

The relationship between the result of a test and the truth underlying the test can be summarized as follows:

	H_0 is True	H_0 is False
Decision: Reject H_0	α	$1-\beta$
Decision: Fail To Reject H_0	$1-\alpha$	β

This can be visualized in terms the distribution of the test statistic under the null and alternative hypotheses. The plot below shows the relationship between power, type I and type II error rates in a right-tailed test of a population mean conducted at the α significance level.



* in the plot above, the green region represents the probability of committing a type II error, the orange region the probability of committing a type I error and the pink/red region is the power of the test.

Below the three panels show the relationship between power, the probability of a type I error and the probability of a type II error.

